



Creative Brief for Website & Digital Marketing

Prepared August 2026 |

Objective

Close JCE's above-the-fold visibility gap so the site converts on the strong search position it already has for removal and pruning terms in its priority geography — recovering the 10–15 qualified leads/week lost to competitors, and resulting in 6–8 more booked jobs/week.

This is not a trust problem, and it's not really an organic SEO problem. JCE ranks well organically and already has the reputation and repeat business (80%+) to win once seen. The gap is that Local Service Ads, paid search, and AI Overviews now sit above organic listings on the results page, and JCE has never had a paid presence to compete for that space. A strong organic ranking no longer guarantees visibility.

Consumer Target

Who: Homeowners 45+ with established properties and mature trees, across River Falls (defend), Hudson & Prescott (build). Not price-sensitive shoppers or out-of-area inquiries.

Need-state priority: Planned work first — removal (especially large-tree and ash-specific jobs) ranks above pruning/trimming. This is the segment where homeowners compare a few estimates before deciding, which is exactly where JCE's proof can win.

What makes them different? They've already decided the work needs doing. The open question isn't whether to act, it's who to trust with their yard, which makes this a comparison-shopping audience, not an awareness one.

Insight

Homeowners comparing tree services can't actually tell who's good from the outside. Every competitor's site says "professional," "certified," and "we protect your property" — the claims have converged to the point where they're no longer differentiating. But before a homeowner even gets to comparing messaging, they have to see JCE at all. Google's results page has

changed: Local Service Ads, paid search, and AI Overviews now occupy the space above organic listings, so even a strong organic rank doesn't put JCE above the fold. JCE has never invested in the placements that now determine who gets seen first.

Key Benefit

No gambling on who shows up, or what your yard looks like when they're done.

Reasons to Believe

- 25 years of local experience in River Falls, celebrated in 2026
- Four ISA-certified arborists, two team members with forestry degrees, four licensed pesticide applicators
- 80%+ repeat-customer rate — proof the job is done right the first time
- Every estimate is a personal property visit, hand-written by an arborist (usually Joe himself), walked through in person or by phone
- A full range of equipment, each piece chosen specifically to protect the lawn and property

Guardrail

Treat River Falls and Hudson/Prescott differently. River Falls: protect the URL structure and organic rank already earned through the re-theme (any URL changes need a redirect plan, since we want to defend our organic ranking), and prioritize closing the paid/LSA gap above it (this is a visibility problem more than a rebuild). Hudson & Prescott: earn rank and build a site presence. Everywhere: the site itself should look and feel as current as JCE's actual standing in the market, since several competitors are visibly ahead on site quality regardless of ranking. And given the claims-convergence problem named above, every claim on the site should be backed by something a competitor can't say on command (a named review, a specific before/after, a real street or property reference.)

Tone & Manner

- Expert, not stuffy — explain clearly, never talk over a homeowner's head
- Warm, with a little humor on planned/everyday content
- Calm, direct, and reassuring specifically on emergency content
- Personal and local — name River Falls, Hudson, and Prescott specifically rather than "our service area"

Scope & functionality

- Core features, prioritized
 -
- User flows or key journeys through the product
- Any existing systems it needs to integrate with?

Design Direction

- Sites I like
- Service pages led by removal, pruning/trimming second
- Photo-led before/after content
- Reviews surfaced with specifics, not star ratings alone
- Estimate/contact CTA pages, plus "what happens after you reach out" content that sets up the personal-estimate visit as the next proof point

Content Direction

Deliverables

- A re-themed Wordpress website (with LocalBusiness, Service, and Review schema implemented site-wide) for all existing pages
- NEW SEO-structured location pages for River Falls, Prescott (I believe he has one for Hudson)
- Landing pages built to convert paid/LSA traffic specifically, since that's the new visitor source this brief is solving for
- A blog where we can add seasonal content (ex winter/frozen-ground trimming, fall oak and ash pruning) tied to when those searches actually spike

Timeline:

Week of August 24th: Brief Patrick + deliver content

Week of August 31: Design & Development

Week of Sept 7: Dev + QA

Week of Sept 14: Launch

APPROVED CONTENT

Homepage

Job of this page: establish JCE as the visibly credentialed, locally-proven choice within the first 3 seconds.

- **Headline: The Highest Standard of Tree Care. No Exceptions.**
- **Subhead:** Trusted in River Falls, Prescott, Hudson and the St Croix River Valley for 25 years
- **Primary CTA:** "Get Your Personal Estimate" → </estimate/>
- **Secondary:** click-to-call phone number, always visible
- **Hero image:** JCE crew on a property.

Trust bar (directly under hero, horizontal strip) 4.9★ Rating · Locally Owned and Operated for 25 Years · 4 ISA-Certified Arborists · HomeAdvisor Elite Service

Anyone with a chainsaw can call themselves a tree service. Not everyone shows up with certified arborists, a fleet of equipment chosen to protect your lawn, and a professional, experienced crew that cleans up like they're leaving their own yard. That's the difference with JCE. For 25 years, we've earned the trust of local homeowners by doing the job right, from start to finish.

Section: Services

Tree Removal → Tree Pruning → Emergency Tree Service → Plant Health Care → Tree Inspection → Lot & Land Clearing → Brush Clean Up / Mowing → Stump Grinding.
Each tile: icon or photo, one-line description, link to service page.

Section: The Personal Estimate

1) You call, we schedule your free estimate.

A local arborist walks your property and figures out what's going on. Sometimes that means the tree comes down. Sometimes it means we tell you it didn't need to. Either way, you get an expert assessment and a clear recommendation on next steps.

2) We walk you through what's needed

You get a hand-written estimate on the spot, and we walk you through it. No callback in three days, no fine print to decode. Just a straight answer while we're standing right there looking at the same tree you are.

3) We schedule the job to fit your needs and the season.

Once you give the go-ahead, we get you on the schedule, timed to the job and the season. A dead ash in July and a leaning oak in January don't call for the same approach, and we'll tell you why.

Section: Credentials

What working with JCE's crew gets you

Local Tree Care Experts

Four ISA Certified Arborists and two forestry-degreed tree professionals on staff mean the person assessing your tree has the training to understand how trees grow, decline, and fail, and can tell you when removal is necessary and when a tree can be saved. It also means the crews working on your property bring deep knowledge of the trees, diseases, and conditions common to our area.

Locally owned and operated for 25 years

That means the owner lives in the same community you do, and you can reach him after the job just as easily as before it. Many of our employees have been with us for many years, and every crew member receives ongoing training to ensure consistently high-quality work.

4.9-star rating across the St. Croix River Valley

That means your neighbors have already put our work to the test on their own properties. We don't filter reviews, and the majority of our business comes from our referrals and repeat customers. We take great pride in our work, and you can expect us to bring that same level of care to your property.

Section: Credentials (Trusted & Credentialed pillar) Not a bare list. Pair each credential with "which means...": e.g., *"Four ISA-certified arborists on staff — which means the person diagnosing your tree's health has the training to be right about it."* Photo of the team, ideally on-site not posed studio shots.

Section: Service Area Map or list treatment: River Falls, Hudson, Prescott (primary), secondary towns (Ellsworth, Beldenville, Roberts, Houlton, Hammond, Baldwin, New Richmond, Spring Valley, Hastings, Afton, Lake St. Croix Beach, Lakeland). Links to the three location pages.

Closing CTA band: repeat phone + estimate CTA.

Section: Reviews 2–3 reviews surfaced with specifics (the actual street, the actual job, the actual outcome), not just star ratings.

SERVICES PAGE

Eyebrow: Tree Removal Near Me

Headline: Tree Removal by Local Tree Experts in the St. Croix River Valley

Body: A dead or hazardous tree isn't something to gamble on. Our arborists don't just take trees down, they know when a tree can be saved and when it can't, and they've got 25 years of judgment behind that call.

Buttons: Get Your Personal Estimate · Call now: [\(715\) 426-0179](tel:7154260179)

Service area: Proudly serving River Falls, Hudson, and Prescott, plus Ellsworth, Beldenville, Roberts, Houlton, Hammond, Baldwin, New Richmond, Spring Valley, Hastings, Afton, Lake St. Croix Beach, and Lakeland.

Trust Strip

★ 4.9 Rating | 4 ISA-Certified Arborists | Locally Owned and Operated for 25 Years | HomeAdvisor Elite Service

How the JCE team works with you to get it done.

1. You call, we schedule your estimate. A local arborist walks your property and figures out what's going on. Sometimes that means the tree comes down. Sometimes it means we tell you it didn't need to. Either way, you get an expert assessment and a clear recommendation on next steps.

2. Hand-written estimate, walked through with you. You get a hand-written estimate on the spot, and we walk you through it. No callback in three days, no fine print to decode. Just a straight answer while we're standing right there looking at the same tree you are.

3. Scheduled to fit your job and the season. Once you give the go-ahead, we get you on the schedule, timed to the job and the season. A dead ash in July and a leaning oak in January don't call for the same approach, and we'll tell you why.

4. Right crew, right equipment. We bring the right crew and the right equipment to the job. JCE's spent 25 years buying gear built to protect a yard, not just get a tree down fast, and that's the same standard the crew's trained to.

5. Meticulous cleanup. Thousands of times over twenty five years we've heard from homeowners that they were so impressed with our clean up. Our crew knows your yard should look better when we leave than it did when we got there. Others will say that, but we've proven over time we're committed to meticulous clean up on every job.

Proof (i'll gather a few more quotes)

A removal on a tight lot

"The JCE Tree Service Team did a great job removing two very large poplars and trimming two others. They have the right equipment to take down big trees in a small area with virtually no property disturbance. I was impressed with their efficiency, professional work, and area clean-up." — Brian Gresback

[Before/after photo pair, same angle, needed]

Removing the Tree Without Damaging the Property

Having the right equipment means the tree comes down without putting the rest of your property at risk. Whether that's your pool, your siding, a fence line, a garden, or landscaping you've spent years on, we plan around it before the work starts. A yard can take real damage from the wrong equipment, or work done at the wrong time of year, which is exactly why JCE has spent 25 years investing in the gear to avoid it.

"Very friendly, competent, and careful. No lawn damage, and great clean-up afterwards." — Ed, on a dead oak removal

[Photo of mats/plywood or drop-zone setup, needed]

Tree Removal Services (we will want photos for each one of these)

Not every tree removal is the same. Some are straightforward. Others require careful planning, specialized equipment and experienced crews to protect your home, property and surrounding trees.

JCE handles tree removals of all sizes, including complex jobs that require advanced equipment and technical expertise.

Good to Know

Every removal includes full cleanup and haul-away of brush and debris. A few things that are handled separately, so there are no surprises on your estimate:

- **Stump grinding is available as an add-on.** If you'd like the stump ground down too, just mention it during your estimate and we'll include it in your quote.
- **Want to keep the wood?** Just ask. We're happy to chip it into woodchips or cut it into rounds and leave it on-site as firewood instead of hauling it away.

Standard Tree Removal

When a tree needs to come down and there's adequate space to work safely, our crew can remove it efficiently with minimal disruption to your property. We carefully plan each removal, take the tree down in manageable sections when needed, and clean up the work area when the job is complete.

Large & Difficult Tree Removal

Large, mature trees can be challenging to remove safely, especially when they are close to homes, garages, fences or other trees. Our team has the equipment and experience to remove large trees efficiently while minimizing impact to your property.

Hazardous & Dead Tree Removal

Dead, dying, leaning or structurally compromised trees can become a serious safety risk. We can evaluate the tree's condition, determine the safest approach and remove it before it causes damage to your home or property.

Storm-Damaged Tree Removal

High winds, heavy snow and severe storms can split trees, break major limbs or leave trees unstable. JCE provides storm-damage removal and cleanup to safely address fallen or hazardous trees.

Specialized Equipment-Assisted & Tight-Access Removal

Some trees cannot be safely removed using conventional methods. When a tree is close to a house, surrounded by landscaping or located in a tight space, our specialized equipment allows us to lift large sections of the tree out in a controlled manner. This can make difficult removals safer, faster and less disruptive to your property.

Diseased or Infested Tree Removal

Emerald ash borer, oak wilt and Dutch elm disease can cause serious damage, but the right course of action depends on the tree, the disease and how far it has progressed. JCE has many years of experience managing these diseases. We can identify what's happening and help you understand your options, from treatment and ongoing protection to removal when a tree can no longer be safely saved.

Tree Pruning

Eyebrow: Tree Pruning & Trimming

Headline: Tree Pruning & Trimming by Local Arborists

Pruning isn't just cutting branches off. Done wrong, it stresses a tree, invites disease, and can ruin its shape for years. Our ISA-certified arborists know how each species responds to a cut, when in the season to make it, and how much a tree can lose and still stay healthy.

We prune for many reasons. Shaping young trees before problems set in. Removing hazardous deadwood. Cleaning up storm damage. Managing a declining ash tree. Timing matters more than people think. Pruning an oak at the wrong time of year risks introducing oak wilt, so we plan the work around your tree's health and the calendar.

Every job starts with a handwritten estimate from an arborist who walks your property and explains exactly what needs to be removed and why. We clean up every branch and twig before we leave.

Emergency Tree Service

Eyebrow: Emergency Tree Service Near Me

Headline: Emergency Tree Removal Services by Local Tree Experts in the St. Croix River Valley

Copy:

Tree on your house? Limb blocking your driveway? Tree down after a storm? Call us now: [\(715\) 426-0179](tel:715426-0179).

If there's any risk to a person or downed power lines are involved, call 911 first. Otherwise, stay clear of the tree and give us a call.

During and after a storm, we're on call and working around the clock, so you'll likely reach someone directly. On a quiet night without storm activity, a call might go to voicemail, but we check it often and call back fast.

We own our crane and grapple saw outright, along with the rest of our equipment fleet, so we can handle large and hazardous jobs and we're not waiting on a subcontractor to show up before we can start working on your property.

Once we're on your property, we assess the situation and make it safe right away. Sometimes that means a full removal on the spot. Other times it means stabilizing the immediate danger and finishing the job once conditions allow. Either way, your yard will look better when we leave than it did when the storm hit. We document the damage and the work as we go and can help you put together what you need for your insurance claim once the job is done.

Plant Health Care

Eyebrow: Tree & Plant Health Care

Headline: Tree Health Care by Certified Arborists and Licensed Pesticide Applicators

Most tree problems are easier to fix, and cheaper, if you catch them early. Our four licensed pesticide applicators and certified arborists diagnose what's going on with a struggling tree and recommend a plan based on that diagnosis.

Getting the diagnosis right matters more than people realize. Most tree diseases can be controlled if you catch them in time, but a few can't, and treating a tree for the wrong problem wastes time it may not have. Our arborists are trained to identify what's affecting your tree before recommending anything.

Treatment depends on what we're dealing with. Fungicides can be sprayed on, injected into the trunk, or applied to the soil around the roots, depending on the disease. For emerald ash borer and several other insects, we use insecticide treatment. Sometimes the better fix isn't a

chemical at all, in fact, pruning, fertilization, or a change in watering habits can reduce disease pressure on a tree that's just stressed. We'll walk you through the option that fits your specific tree and situation.

Emerald ash borer, oak wilt, and Dutch elm disease are all active threats in the St. Croix River Valley right now. Emerald ash borer spreads mainly through moved firewood, over long distances. From late May to September adult female borers fly from tree to tree laying eggs. Oak wilt spreads through root grafts and fresh wounds during warmer months, which is part of why pruning timing matters so much, and Dutch elm disease moves between neighboring elms through root grafts as well as bark beetles. All three are manageable if you catch them early and treat them on the right timeline.

Treatment plans are written out and walked through with you, and we follow up on treated trees so you know whether it worked.

Tree Inspections

Eyebrow: Tree Inspections Near me

Headline: Tree Inspections by ISA-Certified Arborists

Not sure if a tree is a real risk or just looks rough? A certified arborist inspection gives you a straight answer, in writing, before you decide what to do next. Most inspections take 15 to 30 minutes and include written recommendations for any follow-up work.

We examine the whole tree, roots to leaves, along with what's around it. Wind, lightning, and heavy rain are the conditions most tree failures happen in or right after, so we look at exposure to those along with soil conditions, slope, nearby construction, and trenching, since all of them affect how likely a tree is to fail. Every tree carries some risk, and that risk generally grows as a tree gets larger and more mature. Telling a minor flaw apart from a real hazard takes a working knowledge of tree structure and physiology, which is what our certified arborists are trained in.

People call us before buying or selling a property with mature trees, when a tree looks like it's leaning more than it used to, when a neighbor's tree overhangs their yard, or to get a second opinion on a removal quote from someone else.

We walk the property and give you a clear recommendation on the spot as to whether to save it, monitor it, treat it, or remove it. Written documentation is available for insurance, real estate, or municipal needs.

Lot & Land Clearing

Eyebrow: Land & Lot Clearing

Headline: Lot & Land Clearing in the St. Croix River Valley

Whether you're clearing a building site, opening up a pasture, or reclaiming an overgrown property line, land clearing takes the right equipment and a plan.

We walk the property first to understand what's coming out, what's staying, and what the land will be used for next. From a single overgrown lot to several acres, we bring equipment sized to the job. If frozen ground would mean less damage during a winter clearing, we'll tell you that too.

Debris can be hauled off, chipped, or left as usable firewood, whatever works best for you.

Brush Clean Up

Eyebrow: Brush Clean Up

Headline: Brush Clean Up in the St. Croix River Valley

Storm debris, overgrown brush, a pile of branches that's been sitting since last fall. We'll clear it out and haul it away so your property looks the way you want it.

We assess the scope, give you a straightforward estimate, and remove the brush completely. Brush clean-up often pairs well with a removal, pruning, or land clearing job, so ask if bundling makes sense for your project.

Brush Mowing

Eyebrow: Brush Mowing

Headline: Brush Mowing for Overgrown Land in the St. Croix River Valley

For larger overgrown areas like a back pasture, a fence line that's grown in, or land that hasn't been maintained in years brush mowing clears it fast!

We mow down small trees, underbrush, and deadfall to manageable ground cover. Many customers reclaim space taken over by invasive species like buckthorn and cedar. Others want to open up walking trails or clear lanes for deer hunting. Whatever the goal, we'll walk your woods with you and discuss what makes sense for the land, both for your intended use and for the long-term health of the forest. If you're dealing with established trees rather than brush and saplings, see our Land & Lot Clearing page instead.

Stump Grinding

Eyebrow: Stump Grinding

Headline: Stump Grinding in the St. Croix River Valley

A leftover stump can be a tripping hazard, a mower obstacle, or it can simply be in the way of whatever you want to do with that spot next. We grind it down below grade so you can plant, seed, or landscape right over it.

Stump grinding is priced separately from removal, so just ask us to include it in your estimate. We grind the visible stump and root flare, and we can haul away the resulting wood chips or leave them on-site for you to use.

ABOUT US PAGE

Eyebrow: About JCE Tree Service

Headline: 25 Years of Doing Right by People and Trees in our Community.

Subhead: Locally-owned. Arborist-led. The highest standard of tree care. No exceptions.

Our Story

JCE Tree Service started in River Falls in 2001. Twenty-five years later, we're still here, still local, and still running on the same high quality standard we started with.

Today JCE is a crew of 10-12, led by Joe Cardin and Ross Zimmermann, right here in River Falls. Along the way we've added ISA-certified arborists, forestry degrees, licensed pesticide applicators, and a lot more equipment all so we can treat your trees and your property with the same care whether it's a big job or a small one.

Why We Still Do It the Same Way

We built JCE around one rule: the standard doesn't change, job to job, customer to customer. Same crew training. Same equipment. Same guy — usually the owner, Joe — walking your property, writing your estimate by hand, and explaining to you what your trees need. We offer the highest standard of tree care in the area. No exceptions.

That's the whole business model. It's also why more than 8 out of 10 JCE customers call us again.

The Crew Behind the Work

Four ISA-Certified Arborists which means the person diagnosing your tree's health has the training to be right about it, not just confident about it.

Two Team Members with Forestry Degrees which means we understand how trees behave in this climate, this soil, and these species, not tree care in general.

Four Licensed Pesticide Applicators which means treatment application for disease or pests come from people licensed to do the work.

An Owner Who's Spent Decades in These Woods which means the estimate you get reflects 25 years of judgment calls on trees just like yours, in neighborhoods just like yours.

A Crew That Sticks Around many of our team members have been with JCE for years, and every one of them trains on the same quality standard, so the crew that shows up is never a variable.

We Treat Your Yard Like It's Ours

Property damage is the fear nobody tells you they have until it happens to them like the driveway that gets rutted, the flower bed that doesn't survive the truck, the "quick job" that leaves ruts in the lawn for a season. We've spent 25 years buying equipment specifically chosen to avoid that, not just to get a tree down fast. And we clean up like we're the ones who have to look at your yard tomorrow (because in this community, we probably will)!

We're proud to be located in River Falls

We're not a franchise, and we're not a crew that drives in from out of the area to work a job and leave. Joe and Ross live here. So does most of the crew. When we talk about the ash borer problem hitting River Falls and the surrounding area it's because we're dealing with it in our neighborhoods too.

We're proud to support our local community where we can. We enjoy being part of the River Falls Days and the Holidazzle parade, and we support local youth sports and local fundraisers throughout the year. We don't spend a lot of money on advertising, but when we do, we try to support local businesses like WEVR and the Falls Movie Theater. We live here, work here, and we're glad to show up for the community the same way we show up for our customers.

What 25 Years Actually Buys You

- 4.9-star rating, unfiltered, across the St. Croix River Valley
- 80%+ repeat and referral customers — the number that matters more than the star rating
- 4 ISA-Certified Arborists on staff
- HomeAdvisor Elite Service
- Locally owned and operated since 2001

Primary CTA: Get Your Personal Estimate → /estimate/ **Secondary:** Click-to-call phone number, always visible

SERVICE AREA PAGES

RIVER FALLS

Eyebrow: Local Tree Service Proudly Serving River Falls, WI

Headline: The Highest Standard of Tree Care. No Exceptions.

Trusted in River Falls and throughout the St Croix River Valley for 25 years

Get Your Personal Estimate | Call now: (715) 426-0179

Trust bar: 4.9★ Rating · Locally Owned and Operated for 25 Years · 4 ISA-Certified Arborists · HomeAdvisor Elite Service

Intro

Anyone with a chainsaw can call themselves a tree service. Not everyone shows up with certified arborists, a fleet of equipment chosen to protect your lawn, and a professional, experienced crew that cleans up like they're leaving their own yard. That's the difference with JCE. For 25 years, we've earned the trust of homeowners in River Falls by doing the job right, from start to finish.

The Highest Standard of Tree Care. No Exceptions.

We built JCE around one rule: the standard doesn't change, job to job, customer to customer. Same crew training. Same equipment. Same guy — usually the owner, Joe — walking your property, writing your estimate by hand, and explaining to you what your trees need. We offer the highest standard of tree care in the area. No exceptions.

- 4.9★ — Rating across the St. Croix River Valley
- 4 ISA-Certified Arborists, 2
- Locally Owned and Operated for 25 YearsHomeAdvisor Elite Service
- Home Advisor Elite Service

Services

MOST REQUESTED SERVICES (Highlight Tree Removal and Tree Pruning)

1. TREE REMOVAL NEAR ME

Tree Removal by Local Tree Experts in River Falls, WI

A dead or hazardous tree isn't something to gamble on. Our arborists don't just take trees down, they know when a tree can be saved and when it can't, and they've got 25 years of judgment behind that call.

2. Tree Pruning & Trimming Near Me

Tree Pruning & Trimming by Local Tree Experts in River Falls, WI

Regular pruning keeps your trees healthy, shaped, and safe. Our ISA-certified arborists and professional crew know how each species responds to a cut, and when in the season to make it.

3. Tree Health Care Near Me

Tree Health Care by Local Tree Experts in River Falls, WI

Most tree problems are easier (and cheaper!) to fix if you catch them early. Whether you're dealing with disease, pests or a tree in general decline, our certified arborists diagnose what's going on before recommending a treatment plan.

List other services

- Emergency Tree Service: Tree on the house, or a storm-damaged limb? We respond fast. Call (715) 426-0179
- Tree Inspection: An arborist's honest read on what a tree needs, before anything comes down.
- Lot & Land Clearing: Clear ground for a build, a pasture, or a project
- Brush Clean Up & Mowing: Reclaim overgrown areas of your property.
- Stump Grinding: Available as an add-on to any removal — just ask at your estimate.

Process

Section: The Personal Estimate

1) You call, we schedule your free estimate.

A local arborist walks your property and figures out what's going on. Sometimes that means the tree comes down. Sometimes it means we tell you it didn't need to. Either way, you get an expert assessment and a clear recommendation on next steps.

2) We walk you through what's needed

You get a hand-written estimate on the spot, and we walk you through it. No callback in three days, no fine print to decode. Just a straight answer while we're standing right there looking at the same tree you are.

3) We schedule the job to fit your needs and the season.

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Call now: (715) 426-0179

Property-First Care

We Treat Your Yard Like It's Ours

Property damage is the fear nobody tells you they have until it happens to them like the driveway that gets rutted, the flower bed that doesn't survive the truck, the "quick job" that leaves ruts in the lawn for a season. We've spent 25 years buying equipment specifically chosen to avoid that. And we clean up like we're the ones who have to look at your yard tomorrow (because in this community, we probably will)!

Removing the Tree Without Damaging the Property

Having the right equipment means the tree comes down without putting the rest of your property at risk. Whether that's your pool, your siding, a fence line, a garden, or landscaping you've spent years on, we plan around it before the work starts. A yard can take real damage from the wrong equipment, or work done at the wrong time of year, which is exactly why JCE has spent 25 years investing in the gear to avoid it.

Meticulous Cleanup, Every Time

Thousands of times over twenty five years we've heard from homeowners that they were so impressed with our clean up. Our crew knows your yard should look better when we leave than it did when we got there. Others will say that, but we've proven over time we're committed to meticulous clean up on every job.

[Before/after photo pair showing property protection on a **River Falls** job — needed before launch]

Locally Owned & Operated

JCE is located in River Falls, WI, and we've been doing work in **River Falls** and the surrounding area for the last 25 years. You can trust that you can reach JCE and the owner, Joe Cardin, after the job just as easily as before it. Many of our employees have been with us for many years, and every crew member receives ongoing training to ensure consistently high-quality work.

JCE has a 4.9-star rating in Google which means your neighbors have already put our work to the test on their own properties. We don't filter reviews, and the majority of our business comes from our referrals and repeat customers.

Reviews

What Homeowners Say

★★★★★ "The JCE Tree Service Team did a great job removing two very large poplars and trimming two others. They have the right equipment to take down big trees in a small area with virtually no property disturbance." — Brian Gresback

★★★★★ "Very friendly, competent, and careful. No lawn damage, and great clean-up afterwards." — Ed, dead oak removal

Final CTA

The Highest Standard of Tree Care. No Exceptions.

Call now for a free estimate by a certified arborist: (715) 426-0179 | Email Us Instead

Footer

JCE Tree Service · **River Falls, WI** · Serving **River Falls**, Hudson, Prescott & the St. Croix Valley for 25 years

Contact Us

Office Hours: Monday-Friday 9am-4pm

Phone Number:

Wisconsin residents: (715) 426-0179

Minnesota residents: [651-437-0498](tel:651-437-0498).

Email: jcetree@gmail.com

FORM (all required)

Name

Property Address

Phone Number

Email

What can we help you with?

Dropdown or checkboxes:

- Tree removal
- Tree trimming / pruning
- Tree health or disease concern
- Storm damage / emergency cleanup
- Brush or lot clearing
- Not sure / need an arborist's recommendation

Tell us a little about the project

Open text field

Placeholder: *How many trees are involved? What are you noticing? Is the tree near a house, power line, driveway, or other structure?*

Button:

Request My Free Estimate

Confirmation Page: Thank you! Estimate requests completed during the workweek are generally responded to the same day. WEekends will be replied the next day.

FAQ page

We're Answering Questions we Hear from Local Homeowners Below

1. Is there a cost for the estimate?

No. Every estimate is free. Give us a call or send us a request (link to the form) and we'll get a certified arborist out to your property to take a look.

2. How long does it take to get an estimate?

Most homeowners get theirs within a week.

3. How do I pay?

We send an invoice electronically the day after the service is performed. Payment is due within 15 days from invoice date. You can pay by cash, check or card. If you choose to pay by credit or debit card, a 3% processing fee will be automatically added to your bill. Checks can be made out to JCE Tree Service LLC. Unpaid invoices incur a 1.5% late fee each month.

4. How long is the price quote good for?

We hold our price for a full year, unless the owner's put a different timeframe in writing.

5. Once I approve a job, when will it actually get done?

Most jobs get done within four weeks, though it can run longer depending on the season and what's ahead of yours on the schedule. Some tree work can only be done during certain seasons. For example, oak trees can only be pruned in the winter. Large removals sometimes cannot be done when the ground is still soft. If you're working against a deadline, just tell us when you call, or when we're out doing your estimate. We can usually accommodate that if we know ahead of time.

7. Are you insured?

JCE Tree Service is fully insured and licensed, with general liability and workers' comp coverage. We're happy to show you proof if needed. Just ask!

Do I need a permit to remove a tree in WI or MN?

Most private removals don't need a permit in either state, but it depends on your specific city, township, or county. Permits are more likely if your property is near a lake, river, or wetland — which applies to a lot of homes along the St. Croix — within a road right-of-way, or if your municipality protects certain species or larger trees. We'll flag it during your estimate if your property falls into one of those categories.

What happens if something gets damaged on my property?

We plan every job, train our crew, and purchase cutting edge equipment specifically to avoid this. In the rare case something does happen, we're fully insured and we'll make it right. Just talk to us and we'll walk you through it.

Are there grants or assistance programs for removing dead ash trees?

There are no grants available to homeowners in WI or MN.

Will you help document damage for an insurance claim?

Yes. We document the damage and the work as we go, and can help you put together what you need for your insurance claim once the job is done.

Is stump grinding included, or extra?

Stump grinding is priced separately from removal. Just mention it during your estimate and we'll include it in your quote.

What happens to the wood — can I keep it?

Yes — just ask. We're happy to chip it into wood chips or cut it into rounds and leave it on-site as firewood instead of hauling it away.

Jobs Page

Work with us as a Tree Crew Member

JCE Tree Service has been climbing, cutting, and cleaning up after trees in the St. Croix River Valley for 25 years. We're a local, family-owned business located in River Falls, and we've built the whole business around one rule: the standard doesn't change, job to job. That means we're picky about who's on the crew with us.

What we're looking for

Someone hard-working and reliable, first and foremost. The kind of person who shows up on time and does the job right, even when nobody's watching. Tree work experience, a CDL, and climbing experience are a plus, but not required. If you've got the right attitude, we'll train you the rest of the way, and once you're on the team, we'll keep supporting you so you can meet the standard we hold everyone to.

Physical requirements

This is physically demanding, outdoor work in all weather conditions. Crew members should be able to lift and carry 50+ lbs regularly, work at heights (including climbing and aerial equipment), stand and move on uneven or wooded terrain for extended periods, and safely operate chainsaws and other power equipment.

What the job looks like

This is a year-round position, 40–50 hours a week. In the job, you will be working in the St. Croix River Valley (River Falls, Hudson, Prescott, and the surrounding area), working as part of a JCE crew performing hands-on tree care. You will help with removing trees, pruning and trimming branches, clearing brush and storm debris, and grinding stumps, often using chainsaws, chippers, and rigging or climbing equipment. It's physical outdoor work that requires close attention to safety, since the job involves working at heights, around power lines, and with heavy equipment.

Pay & Benefits

Pay is highly competitive and based on experience. JCE offers benefits including paid holidays, \$250 per month toward purchase of your own health insurance, and 401k with 3% employer match.

Why people stick around here

A lot of our crew has been with us for years, and every one of them trains on the same standard. We invest in equipment chosen to protect the properties we work on, so you're working with the right tools. And you'll be learning from a team that includes four ISA-certified arborists, two team members with forestry degrees, and decades of hands-on tree care experience.

How to apply

1. Call us: [\(715\) 426-0179](tel:7154260179)
2. Email: jcetree@gmail.com
3. Fill out our [contact form](#)

JCE Tree Service is an equal employment opportunity employer. All employees and prospective employees are recruited, selected, and trained without regard to age, sex, race, color, religion, disability, national origin, marital status, veteran status, or any other status or characteristic protected by law. JCE Tree Service applies this same standard throughout the employment relationship.

Every applicant is carefully screened, with full consideration given to their training, education, skills, experience, growth potential, and work record. All JCE managers and employees are responsible for actively supporting our equal employment opportunity program.

JCE Tree Service will make reasonable accommodations for qualified individuals with known disabilities, unless doing so would create an undue hardship.